

Sizwe Kamohelo Marole

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Profile

Computer Networking graduate, cum laude, with twelve months of practical networking experience at Oktiq IOT and a sixteen-week cybersecurity internship with MWR CyberSec. Hands-on experience with Cisco networking, Windows and Linux systems, Active Directory and web application security testing, supported by technical reports and practical projects. Currently completing a Postgraduate Diploma in Information Technology and preparing for CompTIA Security+. Seeking an entry-level technology role in IT support, networking, systems or security.

Experience

Computer Networking Intern, Oktiq IOT (Pty) Ltd 20 Nov 2024 to 20 Nov 2025
Placement site: Motheo TVET College, Bloemfontein

- Supported the live campus network at Motheo TVET College, installing and configuring Cisco and MikroTik equipment, switches and structured cabling
- Gave Tier 1 and Tier 2 support to more than 1,000 students and staff, and administered Windows and Linux systems, Active Directory accounts and Group Policy
- Monitored network performance and logs, and used packet capture to trace faults to their root cause
- Connected smart sensors and IoT devices to the network, checking that each one communicated securely and had stable bandwidth
- Restored a non-working CCTV installation by reconfiguring the cameras and correcting their IP addressing

Cybersecurity Virtual Intern, MWR CyberSec (remote) Mar 2026 to Jun 2026
16-week web application security programme, certificate of completion

- Completed the capstone, a black-box web application security assessment of MWR's training portal, using Burp Suite and Kali Linux
- Documented 11 vulnerabilities, including SQL injection, cross-site scripting, broken access control, JWT weaknesses and unrestricted file upload
- Wrote the report with evidence, CVSS v3.1 ratings, CWE and OWASP mapping and remediation advice

Education

Postgraduate Diploma in Information Technology (NQF 8) 2026 to present
Central University of Technology (CUT), distance learning. Results to date: Ethical Hacking 91%, Advanced Research Project 83%

Advanced Diploma in Computer Networking, Cum Laude (NQF 7) 2025, awarded 25 Mar 2026
CUT. Average 80.9%. Infrastructure Design 99%, Network Project 91%, Server Administration 90%, Operating Systems 85%, Information Security 84%

Diploma in Computer Networking, Cum Laude (NQF 6) 2022 to 2024, awarded 26 Mar 2025
CUT. Average 76.8%. Work Integrated Learning 82%, Databases 83%, System Software Development 84%

National Senior Certificate 2020

Projects

Web Application Penetration Test. Black-box assessment with 11 findings (4 High, 1 Medium, 4 Low, 2 Informational). An unrestricted file upload gave remote code execution, and it chained with SQL injection, IDOR and stored XSS to full account takeover. Every finding has reproduction steps, CVSS v3.1, CWE and OWASP mapping, impact and remediation. Sanitised report published on GitHub

Blue Team SOC Lab. Splunk lab on AWS with three detection rules (SSH brute force, Nmap scanning, persistence), eight MITRE ATT&CK mappings and written incident reports

Hybrid Server Infrastructure Lab. Hyper-V, Active Directory, Group Policy hardening, Storage Spaces, File Server Resource Manager, deduplication and server backup

Qhaphela. UNESCO Youth Hackathon 2026 team project: a Chrome extension and Python FastAPI service using a scikit-learn model to flag fraudulent job adverts

Enterprise Network Design. LAN, data centre, internet security and VPN design for a mid-sized organisation

WAN Design. VLSM addressing plan with an EVE-NG simulation

Skills

Networking: TCP/IP, routing and switching, Cisco and MikroTik configuration, VLSM, EVE-NG, network troubleshooting

Systems: Windows Server, Active Directory, Group Policy, Hyper-V, Linux, Bash

Security: Burp Suite, Nmap, Wireshark, tcpdump, Splunk, auditd, OWASP, CVSS, MITRE ATT&CK

Development and tools: Python, FastAPI, Git, GitHub

Certifications and Training

Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900), Microsoft, 2024

Network Security, Cisco Networking Academy, 2024

NDG Linux Essentials, NDG, 2024

MWR CyberSec Virtual Internship, certificate of completion, 2026

TryHackMe: Cyber Security 101, Love at First Breach, Pre Security, 2026

CompTIA Security+: exam preparation, not yet certified

Achievements

Best Student in Advanced Diploma: Computer Networking, CUT, 2025

3rd place, SANReN Cyber Security Challenge National Final, 2025 (Team N0T0R10S)

1st runner up, PAICTA Cybersecurity4D Student Challenge, 2025

Participant, ITWeb Security Summit 2026 Hackathon (CTF Blue Teaming)